



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	7 November 2023	Time of Incident	1100
Directorate / Region	RMO – Midwest Gascoyne	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss - Injury	EQSafe Incident Number	35210
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Three-point turn conducted across carriageway in maintenance truck
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Executive Summary

At approximately 1100 on 7 November 2023, the driver of Routine Maintenance (RM) truck RM1 was heading East along Geraldton-Mt Magnet Road enroute to SLK 19 to assist a separate routine maintenance truck RM6, complete pavement repair. RM1's job was to spot and report oncoming traffic from the crest of a hill to the East of RM6's work site.

The works undertaken were on the opposite (West bound) traffic lane, the driver pulled onto to the left (East bound) shoulder of the road with the intention to conduct a "U" turn across the carriageway.

The driver was unable to complete the "U" turn in one motion and had to await a westbound passing truck (double – Cat 5) before the maintenance truck could reverse back out again and complete a three-point turn.

The westbound passing truck (double – Cat 5) had to steer across the double white lines and into the opposite (East bound) lane to navigate past the maintenance truck.

Incident Photos



Marks on the shoulder shows where the maintenance truck's front wheels were after the first turn across the carriageway, and the centre line where the end of the truck was situated as the Cat- 5 double was passing.



Eastbound line of sight



Westbound line of sight

Contributing Factors

- Failure to follow safe driving rules.
- No direct supervision of the work group on the day, and this is not unusual given the size of the network, mobility of works and the management resources available.
- Failure to assess the risk of completing the "U" turn or stopping on a highway with heavy vehicles approaching and a limited line of site.

Corrective Actions

- Reset behavioural expectations at all levels of the organisation.
- Leaders Induction (all frontline Leaders & Managers) to set expectations and provide guidance on positive interactions.
- Increase of Management presence on Network to influence compliance / safety culture.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- This incident highlights the risk to the public from our core business activities. It also serves as a reminder of the statute duty that all Main Roads employees and Officers owe the public.
- The Regional Risk Register covers the no U-turn position however it is evident that additional content should be considered for clarification and consolidate the position.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Vehicles and Driving

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations